

Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts

Medford School Committee
Special Meeting
February 27, 2018
5:00 p.m.

The special meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order on February 27, 2018 by Mayor Stephanie M. Burke at 5:00 p.m. in the Library Resource center at Medford High School

Members present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot and Mayor Burke (7-0).

Also present: Superintendent Belson, Deputy Superintendent Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Caldwell and Director of Finance and Administration Patterson.

All rose to salute the Flag.

(There is a recorded tape/disc on file as a document)

Mayor Burke stated the purpose of the meeting:

To discuss the current investigation relative to the conduct of the Superintendent of Schools in failing to report an ammunition clip found at the McGlynn Middle School. Further that the discussion will occur in executive session in accordance with purpose 1 of the Open Meeting Law MGL c30A section 21 (a) (1). (see attached letter/notice sent to Roy E. Belson)

Also see posted notice: (attached)

Purpose of the meeting is to continue discussion of security measures and policies for the Medford Public Schools as well as discussion of a public employee personnel complaint.

Member DiBenedetto wanted to allow additional public comment before any executive session. She asked if an Andrews student could speak. The student gave a brief statement that he did not feel safe in school.

High School student/School Committee delegate Justin Tseng spoke on the need to involve students in the planning of school safety measures.

High School student/School Committee delegate Sebastian Tringale also spoke on need to involve students as an untapped resource.

On the motion of Member Van der Kloot seconded by Member Kreatz the School Committee voted to go to executive session:

Vote:

Yea: Van der Kloot, Kreatz, Ruseau, Burke

Nay: DiBenedetto, Ruggiero, Mustone

Motion prevailed 4-3.

The Committee entered executive session at 5:20 p.m.

The School Committee returned from executive session at 9:40 p.m.

The Mayor reported the decision by the School Committee upon return to open session as follows:

1. Superintendent Belson will retire on April 30, 2018
2. He will coordinate security with the Police Department
3. The Superintendent will not make any major appointments of Department Heads, and/or Principals without the approval of the School Committee. Also no non contractual salary changes.
4. ALICE program
5. School Committee will contract with the Superintendent from May 1 to June 30 for 25 hours per week to assist with such items as budget completion/preparation, collective bargaining and transition to a new administration. He will be paid at his current hourly rate.

Voted:

Yea: Van der Kloot, Kreatz, Mustone Ruseau, Burke

Nay: DiBenedetto, Ruggeiro

(5-2)

Mayor Burke also announced the following:

1. There will be a Director of Security for all public buildings
2. There will be a School Safety Advisory Committee
3. There will be a Tip Line in place
4. There will be a security audit of all schools
5. There will be enhanced communication
6. Policies will be upgraded and integrated into all student handbooks and policy manuals. There will be an annual review (see attached).

On the motion of Member Van der Kloot seconded by Member Kreatz the School Committee voted to adopt the above 7-0.

Mayor Burke expressed that the decisions were not taken lightly. That there are many important matters ahead of the School Committee. She recognized the Superintendent for his many contributions over the years.

Mayor Burke asked members for their comments.

Paulette Van der Kloot:

Difficult decision. Superintendent is a good man who made a mistake. 50 years of commitment. I look at the totality of his work.

Kathy Kreatz:

Most difficult decision. Superintendent made a bad decision but nobody was hurt. He had made important contributions over his 23 years. We need to get back to work with community help.

Michael Ruggiero:

It as been a challenging week. Received many communications from the public. Keep it coming. It is valuable.

Erin DiBenedetto:

Zero tolerance for weapons. See something, say something. Important to communicate. Make sure all are safe

Paul Ruseau:

Tough week. Responded to 250 emails this week. Very unique and passionate. Vey conflicted. Not black and white. He felt that the children are safe. Never concerned for his own. No safer place than our schools.

Mea Mustone:

Excited that we have an action plan. Working on a healing service.

Mayor Burke asked Superintendent Belson for his comments:

Apologized for the part he played in the disruption of our school and community. Medford has a bright future. We have a terrific faculty and administration. We will get a lot done and build on a firm foundation. We will grow and work together. We will work with the Police and do everything we can. Thank you for your support.

Mayor Burke expressed her positive feelings for her meeting with the McGlynn faculty and others. It has been difficult but all stood tall. She expressed her thanks.

Meeting was adjourned at 10:06 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,

Kathy Kreatz
Secretary

Posted as Follows:

School Committee Meetings Tuesday, February 27, 2018

The Medford School Committee will hold a special meeting on Tuesday, February 27, 2018 in the Library of Medford High School beginning at 5:00 pm.

The purpose of this meeting is to continue discussion of security measures and policies for the Medford Public Schools

The School Committee intends to enter Executive Session for the following matters:

1. To discuss a public employee personnel complaint under Chapter 30A, Section 21 (a)(1)
2. To discuss deployment of security personnel and/or devices and/or other related security matters under Chapter 30A, Section 21 (a)(4)



City of Medford

OFFICE OF THE MAYOR

City Hall - Room 202
Medford, Massachusetts 02155

Telephone (781) 393-2408

February 23, 2018

STEPHANIE MUCCINI BURKE
MAYOR

FAX: (781) 393-2514

TDD: (781) 393-2516

VIA ELECTRONIC MAIL

Roy Belson
2500 Mystic Valley Pkwy, Apt. 902
Medford, MA 02155
RE: M.G.L., c. 30A, § 21(a)(1) Notice

Dear Mr. Belson:

For your information, the Medford School Committee ("Committee") has scheduled an agenda item for a special meeting on February 27, 2018 to discuss the current investigation relative to your conduct in failing to report an ammunition clip found at the McGlynn Middle School. This agenda item has been scheduled for 5:00PM at the Medford City Hall.

Please be advised that the above-described discussion will occur in executive session in accordance with Purpose I of the Open Meeting Law, M.G.L., c. 30A, § 21(a)(1): "To discuss the reputation, character, physical condition or mental health, rather than professional competence, of an individual, or to discuss the discipline or dismissal of, or complaints or charges brought against, a public officer, employee, staff member or individual." However, at your request, discussion of the complaint may be held in open session.

If the discussion occurs in executive session, you have the following rights:

- (1) to be present at the executive session during deliberations involving you;
- (2) to have counsel or a representative of your own choosing present and attending for the purpose of advising you and not for the purpose of active participation in the executive session;
- (3) to speak on your own behalf; and
- (4) to cause an independent record to be created of the executive session by audio-recording or transcription, at your expense.

See M.G.L., c. 30A, § 21(a)(1).

Thank you for your attention to this correspondence.

Very truly yours,

Stephanie M. Burke, Mayor

cc: Howard Greenspan, Esq.

Incident Report Policy

Policy Definitions

Discovery- finding any object or observing any situation that applies to the safety and security of the school and/ or school district which would negatively impact the wellbeing of students, faculty and staff.

Notification- verbal and/or written communication to the appropriate authority including but not limited to the Police Department

Disposition- reporting of actions taken and conclusions reached that describe and explain the nature of the threat and/or behavior identified as well as any recommendations that emerge from the investigation

Policy

Any individual who discovers an item including but not limited to weapons, ammunition, explosives, drugs, any contraband items shall notify the Medford Police Department immediately and inform the Principal. If the Principal cannot be reached the individual who discovers the item should notify the Superintendent of Schools This process will be in effect on a twenty-four hours a day, seven days a week basis.

As soon as possible, the principal shall prepare a written report surrounding the incident and submit to the Superintendent of Schools.

The school administration will promptly notify parents of situations that may affect the well-being of students, faculty and staff. These notifications will be done consistent with applicable law, regulations and policies of the Medford Public Schools

Additionally, Principals are required to immediately notify the Office of the Superintendent of Schools about other incidents including but not limited to accidents, fires, and suspension/expulsion of students. Written reports concerning the incident(s) must be submitted to the Superintendent no later than the next day following the incident. The Principal or his/her designee must also notify the Mayor and members of the School Committee as soon as possible

Upon disposition of the investigation the Superintendent in conjunction with the Police Department will provide an appropriate written report to the Mayor, School Committee and Principal. This report shall include the facts surrounding the situation, conclusions reached as well as any recommendations to be considered.

This policy will be integrated into all annual reviews, contracts for rentals of our facilities, and school handbooks.